Handout 12: The piece values

REMUS

Remus measures a position in **centipawns**: a pawn is worth 100, so a score of +150 means White stands a pawn and a half ahead. The king has no value because it can never be captured.

Piece	Centipawns	In pawns
Pawn	100	1
Knight	300	3
Bishop	300	3
Rook	500	5
Queen	900	9
King	0	

Material is the first term of `evaluate()`. The score is always given from the side to move's point of view: a position where White is a rook up scores +500 when it is White's turn and -500 when it is Black's. A mate scores `MATE_SCORE - plies`, so a quicker mate scores higher than a slower one, and `MATE_SCORE` is 100,000, larger than any pile of pieces.

The three tactics that win material, to look for in every game Remus plays:

Tactic	What it looks like
Fork	One piece attacks two at once, and only one can be saved
Pin	A piece cannot move without exposing a more valuable piece, or the king, behind it
Skewer	A piece attacks a valuable piece, and when that piece moves away, the piece behind it falls